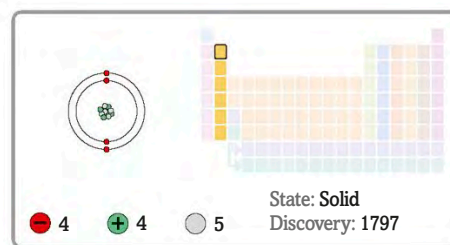


4
Be

Beryllium



Forms

This mineral can also be brown, green, or orange.



Chrysoberyl



Aquamarine

These crystals have this pale blue colour due to iron impurities.

Laboratory sample of pure beryllium



Lightweight metal

Beryllium is found in more than **30 kinds of mineral.**

This widely used element gets its name from the Greek word *beryllos*, after which the mineral beryl is also named. Beryllium is the lightest of the alkaline earth metals, but it does not share many of the group's properties. For example, it does not react with water and is

much harder than the other metals in its group. Two common beryllium minerals are **chrysoberyl** and beryl. Beryl has different forms, such as **aquamarine** and emerald. Beryllium is useful in many ways. For example, some military **helicopters** use windows made